



The Tuatara

1 **Name:** Tuatara (too-a-TAR-rah) is a Māori word meaning 'peaks on the back' or 'spiny back'. The tuatara is also referred to as a 'living fossil' because its appearance has hardly changed in the last 200 million years.

2 **Genus:** *Sphenodon* (s-FEN-a-don) which comes from the Greek, meaning 'wedge tooth'.

3 **Distribution:** Tuatara live on approximately thirty of New Zealand's most inaccessible and predator-free islands. They are thought to have been extinct on the two main islands of New Zealand for hundreds of years, long before European settlement. Tuatara have been a protected species in New Zealand since 1895. With increasingly successful breeding programs, the total population is currently estimated at greater than 60 000.

4 **Appearance:** Tuatara are usually a dull greenish-brown colour which matches their surroundings, especially at night when adults are most active. A tuatara breaks off its tail when it is attacked or caught. It does this because although it takes a long time, the tuatara can regenerate another tail if required. They may look lizard-like but they are actually the only living members of a separate group of related reptiles called Rhynchocephalia (ring-koh-suh-FAH-lee-uh).



Question 1 of 45

species in New Zealand since 1895. With increasingly successful breeding programs, the total population is currently estimated at greater than 60 000.

Appearance: Tuatara are usually a dull greenish-brown colour which matches their surroundings, especially at night when adults are most active. A tuatara breaks off its tail when it is attacked or caught. It does this because although it takes a long time, the tuatara can regenerate another tail if required. They may look lizard-like but they are actually the only living members of a separate group of related reptiles called Rhynchocephalia (ring-koh-suh-FAH-lee-uh).

Size: Tuatara can grow up to 80 centimetres long, with females being smaller than males. They can weigh up to 1.5 kilograms.

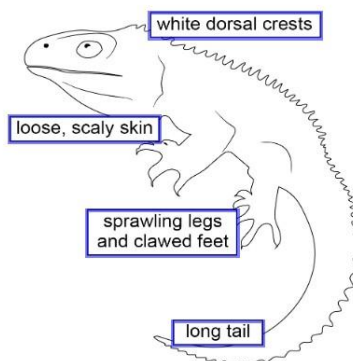
Diet: Tuatara eat insects, bird eggs and chicks, and little lizards or other reptiles, including tuatara young! Tuatara have an unusual second row of upper teeth that help break apart food such as hard-shelled insects. Because tuatara teeth are a part of their jaw bones, the teeth are not replaced when they break off or wear down. As tuatara age, they gradually change their diet to softer foods.

Lifespan: Tuatara are one of the slowest growing reptiles in the world, continuing to grow until they are about 35 years old. They usually live to about 60 years old, but some can live to be over 100.

History: There used to be other animals belonging to the Rhynchocephalia group, but these have only been identified through their fossilised remains. Scientists are particularly interested in studying living tuatara and noting the changes between living and ancient tuatara remains, as well as comparing them to their now extinct relatives.

Text and image: © Janison Solutions Pty Limited

Which part of the tuatara gave it its name?



Flag

Next



Question 2 of 45



The Tuatara

Name: Tuatara (too-a-TAR-rah) is a Māori word meaning 'peaks on the back' or 'spiny back'. The tuatara is also referred to as a 'living fossil' because its appearance has hardly changed in the last 200 million years.

Genus: *Sphenodon* (s-FEN-a-don) which comes from the Greek, meaning 'wedge tooth'.

Distribution: Tuatara live on approximately thirty of New Zealand's most inaccessible and predator-free islands. They are thought to have been extinct on the two main islands of New Zealand for hundreds of years, long before European settlement. Tuatara have been a protected species in New Zealand since 1895. With increasingly successful breeding programs, the total population is currently estimated at greater than 60 000.

Appearance: Tuatara are usually a dull greenish-brown colour which matches their surroundings, especially at night when adults are most active. A tuatara breaks off its tail when it is attacked or caught. It does this because although it takes a long time, the tuatara can regenerate another tail if required. They may look lizard-like but they are actually the only living members of a separate group of related reptiles called Rhynchocephalia (ring-koh-suh-FAH-lee-uh).

Why might tuatara have become extinct on the two main islands of New Zealand?

- ☐ The tuatara had many predators.
- ☐ European settlers killed all the tuatara.
- ☐ The tuatara were not a protected species.
- ☐ The breeding programs were not successful.

Back

Flag

Next



The Tuatara

1 **Name:** Tuatara (too-a-TAR-rah) is a Māori word meaning 'peaks on the back' or 'spiny back'. The tuatara is also referred to as a 'living fossil' because its appearance has hardly changed in the last 200 million years.

2 **Genus:** *Sphenodon* (s-FEN-a-don) which comes from the Greek, meaning 'wedge tooth'.

3 **Distribution:** Tuatara live on approximately thirty of New Zealand's most inaccessible and predator-free islands. They are thought to have been extinct on the two main islands of New Zealand for hundreds of years, long before European settlement. Tuatara have been a protected species in New Zealand since 1895. With increasingly successful breeding programs, the total population is currently estimated at greater than 60 000.

4 **Appearance:** Tuatara are usually a dull greenish-brown colour which matches their surroundings, especially at night when adults are most active. A tuatara breaks off its tail when it is attacked or caught. It does this because although it takes a long time, the tuatara can regenerate another tail if required. They may look lizard-like but they are actually the only living members of a separate group of related reptiles called Rhynchocephalia (ring-koh-suh-FAH-lee-uh).

The colour of the tuatara helps it to

- ☐ keep cool at night.
- ☐ avoid being seen.
- ☐ look like other animals.
- ☐ store energy.

◀ Back

Flag



Next ▶



The Tuatara

1 **Name:** Tuatara (too-a-TAR-rah) is a Māori word meaning 'peaks on the back' or 'spiny back'. The tuatara is also referred to as a 'living fossil' because its appearance has hardly changed in the last 200 million years.

2 **Genus:** *Sphenodon* (s-FEN-a-don) which comes from the Greek, meaning 'wedge tooth'.

3 **Distribution:** Tuatara live on approximately thirty of New Zealand's most inaccessible and predator-free islands. They are thought to have been extinct on the two main islands of New Zealand for hundreds of years, long before European settlement. Tuatara have been a protected species in New Zealand since 1895. With increasingly successful breeding programs, the total population is currently estimated at greater than 60 000.

4 **Appearance:** Tuatara are usually a dull greenish-brown colour which matches their surroundings, especially at night when adults are most active. A tuatara breaks off its tail when it is attacked or caught. It does this because although it takes a long time, the tuatara can regenerate another tail if required. They may look lizard-like but they are actually the only living members of a separate group of related reptiles called Rhynchocephalia (ring-koh-suh-FAH-lee-uh).

5 **Size:** Tuatara can grow up to 80 centimetres long, with females being smaller than males. They can weigh up to 1.5 kilograms.

6 **Diet:** Tuatara eat insects, bird eggs and chicks, and little lizards or other reptiles, including tuatara young! Tuatara have an unusual second row of upper teeth that help break apart food such as hard-shelled insects. Because tuatara teeth are a part of their jaw bones, the teeth are not replaced when they break off or wear down. As tuatara age, they gradually change their diet to softer foods.

7 **Lifespan:** Tuatara are one of the slowest growing reptiles in the world, continuing to grow until they are about 35 years old. They usually live to about 60 years old, but some can live to be over 100.

8 **History:** There used to be other animals belonging to the Rhynchocephalia group, but these have only been identified through their fossilised remains. Scientists are particularly interested in studying living tuatara and noting the changes between living and ancient tuatara remains, as well as comparing them to their now extinct relatives.

Text and image: © Jackson Solutions Pty Limited

'Because tuatara teeth are a part of their jaw bones, the teeth are not replaced when they break off or wear down. As tuatara age, they gradually change their diet to softer foods.' (paragraph 6)
Which of the following can be placed at the beginning of the second sentence?

- ☐ Similarly
- ☐ Alternatively
- ☐ Consequently
- ☐ Additionally



The Tuatara

1 **Name:** Tuatara (too-a-TAR-rah) is a Māori word meaning 'peaks on the back' or 'spiny back'. The tuatara is also referred to as a 'living fossil' because its appearance has hardly changed in the last 200 million years.

2 **Genus:** *Sphenodon* (s-FEN-a-don) which comes from the Greek, meaning 'wedge tooth'.

3 **Distribution:** Tuatara live on approximately thirty of New Zealand's most inaccessible and predator-free islands. They are thought to have been extinct on the two main islands of New Zealand for hundreds of years, long before European settlement. Tuatara have been a protected species in New Zealand since 1895. With increasingly successful breeding programs, the total population is currently estimated at greater than 60 000.

4 **Appearance:** Tuatara are usually a dull greenish-brown colour which matches their surroundings, especially at night when adults are most active. A tuatara breaks off its tail when it is attacked or caught. It does this because although it takes a long time, the tuatara can regenerate another tail if required. They may look lizard-like but they are actually the only living members of a separate group of related reptiles called Rhynchocephalia (ring-koh-suh-FAH-lee-uh).

5 **Size:** Tuatara can grow up to 80 centimetres long, with females being smaller than males. They can weigh up to 1.5 kilograms.

6 **Diet:** Tuatara eat insects, bird eggs and chicks, and little lizards or other reptiles, including tuatara young! Tuatara have an unusual second row of upper teeth that help break apart food such as hard-shelled insects. Because tuatara teeth are a part of their jaw bones, the teeth are not replaced when they break off or wear down. As tuatara age, they gradually change their diet to softer foods.

7 **Lifespan:** Tuatara are one of the slowest growing reptiles in the world, continuing to grow until they are about 35 years old. They usually live to about 60 years old, but some can live to be over 100.

8 **History:** There used to be other animals belonging to the Rhynchocephalia group, but these have only been identified through their fossilised remains. Scientists are particularly interested in studying living tuatara and noting the changes between living and ancient tuatara remains, as well as comparing them to their now extinct relatives.

Text and image: © Jackson Solutions Pty Limited

Which quotation best explains why a tuatara is referred to as a 'living fossil'?

- ☐ 'its appearance has hardly changed in the last 200 million years.' (paragraph 1)
- ☐ '*Sphenodon* (s-FEN-a-don) which comes from the Greek, meaning 'wedge tooth'.' (paragraph 2)
- ☐ 'one of the slowest growing reptiles in the world' (paragraph 7)
- ☐ 'some can live to be over 100' (paragraph 7)



The Tuatara

1 **Name:** Tuatara (too-a-TAR-rah) is a Māori word meaning 'peaks on the back' or 'spiny back'. The tuatara is also referred to as a 'living fossil' because its appearance has hardly changed in the last 200 million years.

2 **Genus:** *Sphenodon* (s-FEN-a-don) which comes from the Greek, meaning 'wedge tooth'.

3 **Distribution:** Tuatara live on approximately thirty of New Zealand's most inaccessible and predator-free islands. They are thought to have been extinct on the two main islands of New Zealand for hundreds of years, long before European settlement. Tuatara have been a protected species in New Zealand since 1895. With increasingly successful breeding programs, the total population is currently estimated at greater than 60 000.

4 **Appearance:** Tuatara are usually a dull greenish-brown colour which matches their surroundings, especially at night when adults are most active. A tuatara breaks off its tail when it is attacked or caught. It does this because although it takes a long time, the tuatara can regenerate another tail if required. They may look lizard-like but they are actually the only living members of a separate group of related reptiles called Rhynchocephalia (ring-koh-suh-FAH-lee-uh).

5 **Size:** Tuatara can grow up to 80 centimetres long, with females being smaller than males. They can weigh up to 1.5 kilograms.

6 **Diet:** Tuatara eat insects, bird eggs and chicks, and little lizards or other reptiles, including tuatara young! Tuatara have an unusual second row of upper teeth that help break apart food such as hard-shelled insects. Because tuatara teeth are a part of their jaw bones, the teeth are not replaced when they break off or wear down. As tuatara age, they gradually change their diet to softer foods.

7 **Lifespan:** Tuatara are one of the slowest growing reptiles in the world, continuing to grow until they are about 35 years old. They usually live to about 60 years old, but some can live to be over 100.

8 **History:** There used to be other animals belonging to the Rhynchocephalia group, but these have only been identified through their fossilised remains. Scientists are particularly interested in studying living tuatara and noting the changes between living and ancient tuatara remains, as well as comparing them to their now extinct relatives.

Text and image: © Jantzen Solutions Pty Limited

Which word can replace 'particularly' in the last paragraph?

- ☐ only
- ☐ generally
- ☐ especially
- ☐ unusually



The Tuatara

- 1 **Name:** Tuatara (too-a-TAR-rah) is a Māori word meaning 'peaks on the back' or 'spiny back'. The tuatara is also referred to as a 'living fossil' because its appearance has hardly changed in the last 200 million years.
- 2 **Genus:** *Sphenodon* (s-FEN-a-don) which comes from the Greek, meaning 'wedge tooth'.
- 3 **Distribution:** Tuatara live on approximately thirty of New Zealand's most inaccessible and predator-free islands. They are thought to have been extinct on the two main islands of New Zealand for hundreds of years, long before European settlement. Tuatara have been a protected species in New Zealand since 1895. With increasingly successful breeding programs, the total population is currently estimated at greater than 60 000.
- 4 **Appearance:** Tuatara are usually a dull greenish-brown colour which matches their surroundings, especially at night when adults are most active. A tuatara breaks off its tail when it is attacked or caught. It does this because although it takes a long time, the tuatara can regenerate another tail if required. They may look lizard-like but they are actually the only living members of a separate group of related reptiles called Rhynchocephalia (ring-koh-suh-FAH-lee-uh).
- 5 **Size:** Tuatara can grow up to 80 centimetres long, with females being smaller than males. They can weigh up to 1.5 kilograms.
- 6 **Diet:** Tuatara eat insects, bird eggs and chicks, and little lizards or other reptiles, including tuatara young! Tuatara have an unusual second row of upper teeth that help break apart food such as hard-shelled insects. Because tuatara teeth are a part of their jaw bones, the teeth are not replaced when they break off or wear down. As tuatara age, they gradually change their diet to softer foods.
- 7 **Lifespan:** Tuatara are one of the slowest growing reptiles in the world, continuing to grow until they are about 35 years old. They usually live to about 60 years old, but some can live to be over 100.
- 8 **History:** There used to be other animals belonging to the Rhynchocephalia group, but these have only been identified through their fossilised remains. Scientists are particularly interested in studying living tuatara and noting the changes between living and ancient tuatara remains, as well as comparing them to their now extinct relatives.

Text and image: © Jankson Solutions Pty Limited

In the text, the letters in brackets show the pronunciation of the previous word, for example 'Tuatara (too-a-TAR-rah)'. The capital letters show the part of the word that

- ☐ is shortened.
- ☐ is in another language.
- ☐ should be shouted.
- ☐ should be emphasised.





The Tuatara

1 **Name:** Tuatara (too-a-TAR-rah) is a Māori word meaning 'peaks on the back' or 'spiny back'. The tuatara is also referred to as a 'living fossil' because its appearance has hardly changed in the last 200 million years.

2 **Genus:** *Sphenodon* (s-FEN-a-don) which comes from the Greek, meaning 'wedge tooth'.

3 **Distribution:** Tuatara live on approximately thirty of New Zealand's most inaccessible and predator-free islands. They are thought to have been extinct on the two main islands of New Zealand for hundreds of years, long before European settlement. Tuatara have been a protected species in New Zealand since 1895. With increasingly successful breeding programs, the total population is currently estimated at greater than 60 000.

4 **Appearance:** Tuatara are usually a dull greenish-brown colour which matches their surroundings, especially at night when adults are most active. A tuatara breaks off its tail when it is attacked or caught. It does this because although it takes a long time, the tuatara can regenerate another tail if required. They may look lizard-like but they are actually the only living members of a separate group of related reptiles called Rhynchocephalia (ring-koh-suh-FAH-lee-uh).

5 **Size:** Tuatara can grow up to 80 centimetres long, with females being smaller than males. They can weigh up to 1.5 kilograms.

6 **Diet:** Tuatara eat insects, bird eggs and chicks, and little lizards or other reptiles, including tuatara young! Tuatara have an unusual second row of upper teeth that help break apart food such as hard-shelled insects. Because tuatara teeth are a part of their jaw bones, the teeth are not replaced when they break off or wear down. As tuatara age, they gradually change their diet to softer foods.

7 **Lifespan:** Tuatara are one of the slowest growing reptiles in the world, continuing to grow until they are about 35 years old. They usually live to about 60 years old, but some can live to be over 100.

8 **History:** There used to be other animals belonging to the Rhynchocephalia group, but these have only been identified through their fossilised remains. Scientists are particularly interested in studying living tuatara and noting the changes between living and ancient tuatara remains, as well as comparing them to their now extinct relatives.

Text and image: © Jambon Solutions Pty Limited

Why does the writer use subheadings in the text?

- ☐ to make the text look more interesting
- ☐ to list the differences between tuatara and other animals
- ☐ to help readers find information easily
- ☐ to show the range of knowledge about the topic



LUCKY CHARM



- 1 The soccer field bustled with chatter.
- 2 'Game starts in ten minutes,' said the coach.
- 3 Ben nodded, sipping nervously from his water bottle.
- 4 Coach Tanner narrowed his eyes. 'Ben, you can't wear those red shoelaces. You know it's not part of the uniform. They must be black.'
- 5 A ball of fear formed in Ben's stomach. His shoelaces were lucky. They had been a gift from his best friend, Harry.
- 6 As if reading Ben's thoughts, the coach patted him on the head. 'Sorry, Ben, but the rules are the rules.'
- Minutes later, Ben stood on the soccer field with black laces in his boots. The game whistle sounded. Players sprang into motion, darting in all directions. The ball rolled across the damp grass. He leapt forward and intercepted it in one swift move. He raced past players from the opposing team. He glanced down to decide his next move and for that split-second, was distracted by his boring, black, unlucky shoelaces. From out of nowhere, the ball was stolen from under his feet.
- Coach Tanner jumped up and down on the sideline. Heart racing, Ben ran to catch up. *See, they are unlucky laces!* He paused momentarily, trying to steady his breath. He remembered the day Harry had given him the laces. Harry was the first real friend Ben had ever had. Then he had moved away. They hardly spoke anymore. It had been Harry who had encouraged Ben to play soccer in the first place. He'd even taught him how to do a scissor kick. It had taken Ben over forty-five attempts, but finally he'd managed to kick the ball. He giggled at the memory. Ben wished he could make another friend like that. Harry had always encouraged him to keep trying. 'Never give up!' he would say, with a playful punch. Harry wasn't only referring to soccer either.
- 8 Ben lifted his gaze. The ball was coming in his direction. He controlled the pass and dribbled directly towards the goalie. The crowd erupted.
- 9 'Shoot it!' yelled someone from the sideline. He swung his leg back and booted the ball. It spun as it catapulted through the air.
- 10 Ben smiled. He remembered how lucky he was to have a friend like Harry.
- 11 The ball zoomed past the goalie and into the net.
- 12

Text: © Jantzen Solutions Pty Limited

When Coach Tanner told Ben he couldn't wear his red shoelaces, what was Ben worried about?

- ☐ that Harry would be upset with him
- ☐ that he would forget about Harry
- ☐ that he would be distracted by black shoelaces
- ☐ that he would perform poorly in the game

Back

Flag



Next



LUCKY CHARM



- 1 The soccer field bustled with chatter.
- 2 'Game starts in ten minutes,' said the coach.
- 3 Ben nodded, sipping nervously from his water bottle.
- 4 Coach Tanner narrowed his eyes. 'Ben, you can't wear those red shoelaces. You know it's not part of the uniform. They must be black.'
- 5 A ball of fear formed in Ben's stomach. His shoelaces were lucky. They had been a gift from his best friend, Harry.
- 6 As if reading Ben's thoughts, the coach patted him on the head. 'Sorry, Ben, but the rules are the rules.'
- Minutes later, Ben stood on the soccer field with black laces in his boots. The game whistle sounded. Players sprang into motion, darting in all directions. The ball rolled across the damp grass. He leapt forward and intercepted it in one swift move. He raced past players from the opposing team. He glanced down to decide his next move and for that split-second, was distracted by his boring, black, unlucky shoelaces. From out of nowhere, the ball was stolen from under his feet.
- 7 Coach Tanner jumped up and down on the sideline. Heart racing, Ben ran to catch up. *See, they are unlucky laces!* He paused momentarily, trying to steady his breath. He remembered the day Harry had given him the laces. Harry was the first real friend Ben had ever had. Then he had moved away. They hardly spoke anymore. It had been Harry who had encouraged Ben to play soccer in the first place. He'd even taught him how to do a scissor kick. It had taken Ben over forty-five attempts, but finally he'd managed to kick the ball. He giggled at the memory. Ben wished he could make another friend like that. Harry had always encouraged him to keep trying. 'Never give up!' he would say, with a playful punch. Harry wasn't only referring to soccer either.
- 8 Ben lifted his gaze. The ball was coming in his direction. He controlled the pass and dribbled directly towards the goalie. The crowd erupted.
- 9 'Shoot it!' yelled someone from the sideline. He swung his leg back and booted the ball. It spun as it catapulted through the air.
- 10 Ben smiled. He remembered how lucky he was to have a friend like Harry.
- 11 The ball zoomed past the goalie and into the net.
- 12

Text: © Jantzen Solutions Pty Limited

'Sorry, Ben, but the rules are the rules.'

(paragraph 6)

Coach Tanner's tone of voice was most likely

- ☐ strict.
- ☐ disappointed.
- ☐ curious.
- ☐ sympathetic.





LUCKY CHARM



- 1 The soccer field bustled with chatter.
- 2 'Game starts in ten minutes,' said the coach.
- 3 Ben nodded, sipping nervously from his water bottle.
- 4 Coach Tanner narrowed his eyes. 'Ben, you can't wear those red shoelaces. You know it's not part of the uniform. They must be black.'
- 5 A ball of fear formed in Ben's stomach. His shoelaces were lucky. They had been a gift from his best friend, Harry.
- 6 As if reading Ben's thoughts, the coach patted him on the head. 'Sorry, Ben, but the rules are the rules.'
- Minutes later, Ben stood on the soccer field with black laces in his boots. The game whistle sounded. Players sprang into motion, darting in all directions. The ball rolled across the damp grass. He leapt forward and intercepted it in one swift move. He raced past players from the opposing team. He glanced down to decide his next move and for that split-second, was distracted by his boring, black, unlucky shoelaces. From out of nowhere, the ball was stolen from under his feet.
- Coach Tanner jumped up and down on the sideline. Heart racing, Ben ran to catch up. *See, they are unlucky laces!* He paused momentarily, trying to steady his breath. He remembered the day Harry had given him the laces. Harry was the first real friend Ben had ever had. Then he had moved away. They hardly spoke anymore. It had been Harry who had encouraged Ben to play soccer in the first place. He'd even taught him how to do a scissor kick. It had taken Ben over forty-five attempts, but finally he'd managed to kick the ball. He giggled at the memory. Ben wished he could make another friend like that. Harry had always encouraged him to keep trying. 'Never give up!' he would say, with a playful punch. Harry wasn't only referring to soccer either.
- 8 Ben lifted his gaze. The ball was coming in his direction. He controlled the pass and dribbled directly towards the goalie. The crowd erupted.
- 9 'Shoot it!' yelled someone from the sideline. He swung his leg back and booted the ball. It spun as it catapulted through the air.
- 10 Ben smiled. He remembered how lucky he was to have a friend like Harry.
- 11 The ball zoomed past the goalie and into the net.
- 12

Text: © Jamieson Solutions Pty Limited

Choose the word that best shows the players had been eager for the game to start.

'Players **sprang** into motion, **darting** in all directions.' (paragraph 7)

◀ Back

Flag



Next ▶



LUCKY CHARM



- 1 The soccer field bustled with chatter.
- 2 'Game starts in ten minutes,' said the coach.
- 3 Ben nodded, sipping nervously from his water bottle.
- 4 Coach Tanner narrowed his eyes. 'Ben, you can't wear those red shoelaces. You know it's not part of the uniform. They must be black.'
- 5 A ball of fear formed in Ben's stomach. His shoelaces were lucky. They had been a gift from his best friend, Harry.
- 6 As if reading Ben's thoughts, the coach patted him on the head. 'Sorry, Ben, but the rules are the rules.'
- Minutes later, Ben stood on the soccer field with black laces in his boots. The game whistle sounded. Players sprang into motion, darting in all directions. The ball rolled across the damp grass. He leapt forward and intercepted it in one swift move. He raced past players from the opposing team. He glanced down to decide his next move and for that split-second, was distracted by his boring, black, unlucky shoelaces. From out of nowhere, the ball was stolen from under his feet.
- Coach Tanner jumped up and down on the sideline. Heart racing, Ben ran to catch up. *See, they are unlucky laces!* He paused momentarily, trying to steady his breath. He remembered the day Harry had given him the laces. Harry was the first real friend Ben had ever had. Then he had moved away. They hardly spoke anymore. It had been Harry who had encouraged Ben to play soccer in the first place. He'd even taught him how to do a scissor kick. It had taken Ben over forty-five attempts, but finally he'd managed to kick the ball. He giggled at the memory. Ben wished he could make another friend like that. Harry had always encouraged him to keep trying. 'Never give up!' he would say, with a playful punch. Harry wasn't only referring to soccer either.
- 8 Ben lifted his gaze. The ball was coming in his direction. He controlled the pass and dribbled directly towards the goalie. The crowd erupted.
- 9 'Shoot it!' yelled someone from the sideline. He swung his leg back and booted the ball. It spun as it catapulted through the air.
- 10 Ben smiled. He remembered how lucky he was to have a friend like Harry.
- 11 The ball zoomed past the goalie and into the net.
- 12

Text: © Janson Solutions Pty Limited

In the seventh paragraph, the writer uses the word 'stolen' to make it appear that

- ☐ the opposing player was cheating.
- ☐ Ben was not concentrating.
- ☐ Ben was injured when the ball was taken away.
- ☐ the opposing player would not give the ball back.

LUCKY CHARM



- 1 The soccer field bustled with chatter.
- 2 'Game starts in ten minutes,' said the coach.
- 3 Ben nodded, sipping nervously from his water bottle.
- 4 Coach Tanner narrowed his eyes. 'Ben, you can't wear those red shoelaces. You know it's not part of the uniform. They must be black.'
- 5 A ball of fear formed in Ben's stomach. His shoelaces were lucky. They had been a gift from his best friend, Harry.
- 6 As if reading Ben's thoughts, the coach patted him on the head. 'Sorry, Ben, but the rules are the rules.'
- Minutes later, Ben stood on the soccer field with black laces in his boots. The game whistle sounded. Players sprang into motion, darting in all directions. The ball rolled across the damp grass. He leapt forward and intercepted it in one swift move. He raced past players from the opposing team. He glanced down to decide his next move and for that split-second, was distracted by his boring, black, unlucky shoelaces. From out of nowhere, the ball was stolen from under his feet.
- Coach Tanner jumped up and down on the sideline. Heart racing, Ben ran to catch up. *See, they are unlucky laces!* He paused momentarily, trying to steady his breath. He remembered the day Harry had given him the laces. Harry was the first real friend Ben had ever had. Then he had moved away. They hardly spoke anymore. It had been Harry who had encouraged Ben to play soccer in the first place. He'd even taught him how to do a scissor kick. It had taken Ben over forty-five attempts, but finally he'd managed to kick the ball. He giggled at the memory. Ben wished he could make another friend like that. Harry had always encouraged him to keep trying. 'Never give up!' he would say, with a playful punch. Harry wasn't only referring to soccer either.
- 8 Ben lifted his gaze. The ball was coming in his direction. He controlled the pass and dribbled directly towards the goalie. The crowd erupted.
- 9 'Shoot it!' yelled someone from the sideline. He swung his leg back and booted the ball. It spun as it catapulted through the air.
- 10 Ben smiled. He remembered how lucky he was to have a friend like Harry.
- 11 The ball zoomed past the goalie and into the net.
- 12

Text: © Jamieson Solutions Pty Limited

'He'd even taught him how to do a scissor kick.'
(paragraph 8)

What two words make up 'He'd'?

- ☐ He did
- ☐ He does
- ☐ He had
- ☐ He would

LUCKY CHARM



- 1 The soccer field bustled with chatter.
- 2 'Game starts in ten minutes,' said the coach.
- 3 Ben nodded, sipping nervously from his water bottle.
- 4 Coach Tanner narrowed his eyes. 'Ben, you can't wear those red shoelaces. You know it's not part of the uniform. They must be black.'
- 5 A ball of fear formed in Ben's stomach. His shoelaces were lucky. They had been a gift from his best friend, Harry.
- 6 As if reading Ben's thoughts, the coach patted him on the head. 'Sorry, Ben, but the rules are the rules.'
- Minutes later, Ben stood on the soccer field with black laces in his boots. The game whistle sounded. Players sprang into motion, darting in all directions. The ball rolled across the damp grass. He leapt forward and intercepted it in one swift move. He raced past players from the opposing team. He glanced down to decide his next move and for that split-second, was distracted by his boring, black, unlucky shoelaces. From out of nowhere, the ball was stolen from under his feet.
- Coach Tanner jumped up and down on the sideline. Heart racing, Ben ran to catch up. *See, they are unlucky laces!* He paused momentarily, trying to steady his breath. He remembered the day Harry had given him the laces. Harry was the first real friend Ben had ever had. Then he had moved away. They hardly spoke anymore. It had been Harry who had encouraged Ben to play soccer in the first place. He'd even taught him how to do a scissor kick. It had taken Ben over forty-five attempts, but finally he'd managed to kick the ball. He giggled at the memory. Ben wished he could make another friend like that. Harry had always encouraged him to keep trying. 'Never give up!' he would say, with a playful punch. Harry wasn't only referring to soccer either.
- 8 Ben lifted his gaze. The ball was coming in his direction. He controlled the pass and dribbled directly towards the goalie. The crowd erupted.
- 9 'Shoot it!' yelled someone from the sideline. He swung his leg back and booted the ball. It spun as it catapulted through the air.
- 10 Ben smiled. He remembered how lucky he was to have a friend like Harry.
- 11 The ball zoomed past the goalie and into the net.
- 12

Text: © Jamboree Solutions Pty Limited

What helped Ben to complete his first scissor kick successfully?

- ☐ Harry's encouragement
- ☐ good luck
- ☐ great skill
- ☐ the lucky laces

◀ Back

Flag



Next ▶



LUCKY CHARM



- 1 The soccer field bustled with chatter.
- 2 'Game starts in ten minutes,' said the coach.
- 3 Ben nodded, sipping nervously from his water bottle.
- 4 Coach Tanner narrowed his eyes. 'Ben, you can't wear those red shoelaces. You know it's not part of the uniform. They must be black.'
- 5 A ball of fear formed in Ben's stomach. His shoelaces were lucky. They had been a gift from his best friend, Harry.
- 6 As if reading Ben's thoughts, the coach patted him on the head. 'Sorry, Ben, but the rules are the rules.'
- Minutes later, Ben stood on the soccer field with black laces in his boots. The game whistle sounded. Players sprang into motion, darting in all directions. The ball rolled across the damp grass. He leapt forward and intercepted it in one swift move. He raced past players from the opposing team. He glanced down to decide his next move and for that split-second, was distracted by his boring, black, unlucky shoelaces. From out of nowhere, the ball was stolen from under his feet.
- 7 Coach Tanner jumped up and down on the sideline. Heart racing, Ben ran to catch up. *See, they are unlucky laces!* He paused momentarily, trying to steady his breath. He remembered the day Harry had given him the laces. Harry was the first real friend Ben had ever had. Then he had moved away. They hardly spoke anymore. It had been Harry who had encouraged Ben to play soccer in the first place. He'd even taught him how to do a scissor kick. It had taken Ben over forty-five attempts, but finally he'd managed to kick the ball. He giggled at the memory. Ben wished he could make another friend like that. Harry had always encouraged him to keep trying. 'Never give up!' he would say, with a playful punch. Harry wasn't only referring to soccer either.
- 8 Ben lifted his gaze. The ball was coming in his direction. He controlled the pass and dribbled directly towards the goalie. The crowd erupted.
- 9 'Shoot it!' yelled someone from the sideline. He swung his leg back and booted the ball. It spun as it catapulted through the air.
- 10 Ben smiled. He remembered how lucky he was to have a friend like Harry.
- 11 The ball zoomed past the goalie and into the net.

Text: © Jambon Solutions Pty Limited

The writer uses the words 'giggled' (paragraph 8) and 'smiled' (paragraph 11) to show that

- ☐ Ben had happy memories of Harry.
- ☐ Ben was being silly and not focussing on the game.
- ☐ Ben felt happy about scoring a goal.
- ☐ Ben was glad Harry taught him to play soccer.



LUCKY CHARM



- 1 The soccer field bustled with chatter.
- 2 'Game starts in ten minutes,' said the coach.
- 3 Ben nodded, sipping nervously from his water bottle.
- 4 Coach Tanner narrowed his eyes. 'Ben, you can't wear those red shoelaces. You know it's not part of the uniform. They must be black.'
- 5 A ball of fear formed in Ben's stomach. His shoelaces were lucky. They had been a gift from his best friend, Harry.
- 6 As if reading Ben's thoughts, the coach patted him on the head. 'Sorry, Ben, but the rules are the rules.'
- Minutes later, Ben stood on the soccer field with black laces in his boots. The game whistle sounded. Players sprang into motion, darting in all directions. The ball rolled across the damp grass. He leapt forward and intercepted it in one swift move. He raced past players from the opposing team. He glanced down to decide his next move and for that split-second, was distracted by his boring, black, unlucky shoelaces. From out of nowhere, the ball was stolen from under his feet.
- 7 Coach Tanner jumped up and down on the sideline. Heart racing, Ben ran to catch up. *See, they are unlucky laces!* He paused momentarily, trying to steady his breath. He remembered the day Harry had given him the laces. Harry was the first real friend Ben had ever had. Then he had moved away. They hardly spoke anymore. It had been Harry who had encouraged Ben to play soccer in the first place. He'd even taught him how to do a scissor kick. It had taken Ben over forty-five attempts, but finally he'd managed to kick the ball. He giggled at the memory. Ben wished he could make another friend like that. Harry had always encouraged him to keep trying. 'Never give up!' he would say, with a playful punch. Harry wasn't only referring to soccer either.
- 8 Ben lifted his gaze. The ball was coming in his direction. He controlled the pass and dribbled directly towards the goalie. The crowd erupted.
- 9 'Shoot it!' yelled someone from the sideline. He swung his leg back and booted the ball. It spun as it catapulted through the air.
- 10 Ben smiled. He remembered how lucky he was to have a friend like Harry.
- 11 The ball zoomed past the goalie and into the net.
- 12

Text: © Jamison Solutions Pty Limited

In the end, Ben realises that the lucky charm is

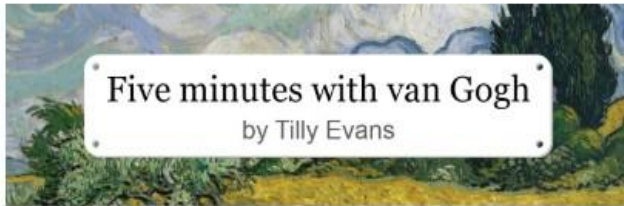
- ☐ his pair of red shoelaces.
- ☐ the black shoelaces.
- ☐ his friendship with Harry.
- ☐ the support from the crowd.

◀ Back

Flag



Next ▶



Five minutes with van Gogh

by Tilly Evans

Maybe you already know the name 'van Gogh' but do you know much about his paintings? Well, you can find out here in this 'interview'. But wait, you must be thinking, how can I interview someone who isn't alive? By using his letters to his brother Theo (and my own research, of course!), I imagined van Gogh's answers.

Quick facts

- **Name:** Vincent Willem van Gogh
- **Occupation:** artist, painter
- **Nationality:** Dutch
- **Born:** March 30, 1853, in Zundert, Netherlands
- **Died:** July 29, 1890, in Auvers-sur-Oise, France (aged 37)

Your paintings look like they're moving. How and why did you paint like this?

I wanted to capture everyday life and to express true human feeling. As a result, I hoped people would learn a new way of 'seeing'. When I painted a scene, I used swirly broken lines and bold brushstrokes to show movement as well as my feelings. However, this was not the 'normal' style of the time and my work was often criticised.

Really? You mean no-one liked your paintings?

Yes! No-one wanted my paintings. I only sold one while I was alive. I couldn't do anything about whether or not my paintings sold. Some weeks I would go hungry because I spent the little money I had on art supplies instead. I believed that one day my paintings would be worth more than the cost of the paint and the struggle it took to create them.

Wow! In our times, you are one of the most famous painters in history. Those paintings that no-one wanted are now worth millions of dollars. What do you think about your fame?

I think that if I am worth something today then I was worth something then. I am thankful to my sister-in-law Jo who, despite being a single mother, worked tirelessly to promote my work.

If you could be a colour, what would you be and why?

I used colours to capture feelings rather than to represent what is actually real. When I was painting, I always thought how lovely yellow is! It stands for the sun, and to me, yellow embodies happiness.

In the first paragraph, the words 'of course' show that the interviewer is

- ☐ enthusiastic about the interview.
- ☐ stating what should be obvious.
- ☐ surprised she is talking to van Gogh.
- ☐ impressed that she did some research.



Five minutes with van Gogh

by Tilly Evans

1 Maybe you already know the name 'van Gogh' but do you know much about his paintings? Well, you can find out here in this 'interview'. But wait, you must be thinking, how can I interview someone who isn't alive? By using his letters to his brother Theo (and my own research, of course!), I imagined van Gogh's answers.

Quick facts

- **Name:** Vincent Willem van Gogh
- **Occupation:** artist, painter
- 2 • **Nationality:** Dutch
- **Born:** March 30, 1853, in Zundert, Netherlands
- **Died:** July 29, 1890, in Auvers-sur-Oise, France (aged 37)

3 **Your paintings look like they're moving. How and why did you paint like this?**

I wanted to capture everyday life and to express true human feeling. As a result, I hoped people would learn a new way of 'seeing'. When I painted a scene, I used swirly broken lines and bold brushstrokes to show movement as well as my feelings. However, this was not the 'normal' style of the time and my work was often criticised.

5 **Really? You mean no-one liked your paintings?**

Yes! No-one wanted my paintings. I only sold one while I was alive. I couldn't do anything about whether or not my paintings sold. Some weeks I would go hungry because I spent the little money I had on art supplies instead. I believed that one day my paintings would be worth more than the cost of the paint and the struggle it took to create them.

7 **Wow! In our times, you are one of the most famous painters in history. Those paintings that no-one wanted are now worth millions of dollars. What do you think about your fame?**

I think that if I am worth something today then I was worth something then. I am thankful to my sister-in-law Jo who, despite being a single mother, worked tirelessly to promote my work.

9 **If you could be a colour, what would you be and why?**

10 I used colours to capture feelings rather than to represent what is actually real. When I was painting, I always thought how lovely yellow is! It stands for the sun, and to me, yellow embodies happiness.

Text: © Jemson Solutions Pty Limited. Image: See acknowledgements.

Which best describes the information in the second paragraph?

- ☐ a summary of topics covered in the rest of the text
- ☐ basic information about van Gogh
- ☐ things readers already know about van Gogh
- ☐ a list of the writer's favourite facts about van Gogh

◀ Back

Flag



Next ▶



Five minutes with van Gogh

by Tilly Evans

Maybe you already know the name 'van Gogh' but do you know much about his paintings? Well, you can find out here in this 'interview'. But wait, you must be thinking, how can I interview someone who isn't alive? By using his letters to his brother Theo (and my own research, of course!), I imagined van Gogh's answers.

Quick facts

- **Name:** Vincent Willem van Gogh
- **Occupation:** artist, painter
- **Nationality:** Dutch
- **Born:** March 30, 1853, in Zundert, Netherlands
- **Died:** July 29, 1890, in Auvers-sur-Oise, France (aged 37)

Your paintings look like they're moving. How and why did you paint like this?

I wanted to capture everyday life and to express true human feeling. As a result, I hoped people would learn a new way of 'seeing'. When I painted a scene, I used swirly broken lines and bold brushstrokes to show movement as well as my feelings. However, this was not the 'normal' style of the time and my work was often criticised.

Really? You mean no-one liked your paintings?

Yes! No-one wanted my paintings. I only sold one while I was alive. I couldn't do anything about whether or not my paintings sold. Some weeks I would go hungry because I spent the little money I had on art supplies instead. I believed that one day my paintings would be worth more than the cost of the paint and the struggle it took to create them.

Wow! In our times, you are one of the most famous painters in history. Those paintings that no-one wanted are now worth millions of dollars. What do you think about your fame?

I think that if I am worth something today then I was worth something then. I am thankful to my sister-in-law Jo who, despite being a single mother, worked tirelessly to promote my work.

If you could be a colour, what would you be and why?

I used colours to capture feelings rather than to represent what is actually real. When I was painting, I always thought how lovely yellow is! It stands for the sun, and to me, yellow embodies happiness.

When van Gogh said he wanted his paintings 'to capture everyday life', he wanted to

- ☐ include lots of people in them.
- ☐ describe what he normally did.
- ☐ show events happening around him.
- ☐ use very realistic colours in them.



Five minutes with van Gogh

by Tilly Evans

Maybe you already know the name 'van Gogh' but do you know much about his paintings? Well, you can find out here in this 'interview'. But wait, you must be thinking, how can I interview someone who isn't alive? By using his letters to his brother Theo (and my own research, of course!), I imagined van Gogh's answers.

Quick facts

- **Name:** Vincent Willem van Gogh
- **Occupation:** artist, painter
- **Nationality:** Dutch
- **Born:** March 30, 1853, in Zundert, Netherlands
- **Died:** July 29, 1890, in Auvers-sur-Oise, France (aged 37)

Your paintings look like they're moving. How and why did you paint like this?

I wanted to capture everyday life and to express true human feeling. As a result, I hoped people would learn a new way of 'seeing'. When I painted a scene, I used swirly broken lines and bold brushstrokes to show movement as well as my feelings. However, this was not the 'normal' style of the time and my work was often criticised.

Really? You mean no-one liked your paintings?

Yes! No-one wanted my paintings. I only sold one while I was alive. I couldn't do anything about whether or not my paintings sold. Some weeks I would go hungry because I spent the little money I had on art supplies instead. I believed that one day my paintings would be worth more than the cost of the paint and the struggle it took to create them.

Wow! In our times, you are one of the most famous painters in history. Those paintings that no-one wanted are now worth millions of dollars. What do you think about your fame?

I think that if I am worth something today then I was worth something then. I am thankful to my sister-in-law Jo who, despite being a single mother, worked tirelessly to promote my work.

If you could be a colour, what would you be and why?

I used colours to capture feelings rather than to represent what is actually real. When I was painting, I always thought how lovely yellow is! It stands for the sun, and to me, yellow embodies happiness.

(Art: © Janssen Solutions Pty Limited. Image: See acknowledgements.)

In the fourth paragraph, why are quotation marks used around the word 'seeing'?

- ☐ to indicate it is a technical term
- ☐ to show it is something only van Gogh could do
- ☐ to identify it is another person speaking
- ☐ to show it is different to the usual meaning



Five minutes with van Gogh

by Tilly Evans

- 1 Maybe you already know the name 'van Gogh' but do you know much about his paintings? Well, you can find out here in this 'interview'. But wait, you must be thinking, how can I interview someone who isn't alive? By using his letters to his brother Theo (and my own research, of course!), I imagined van Gogh's answers.

Quick facts

- **Name:** Vincent Willem van Gogh
- **Occupation:** artist, painter
- 2 • **Nationality:** Dutch
- **Born:** March 30, 1853, in Zundert, Netherlands
- **Died:** July 29, 1890, in Auvers-sur-Oise, France (aged 37)

- 3 **Your paintings look like they're moving. How and why did you paint like this?**

I wanted to capture everyday life and to express true human feeling. As a result, I hoped people would learn a new way of 'seeing'. When I painted a scene, I used swirly broken lines and bold brushstrokes to show movement as well as my feelings. However, this was not the 'normal' style of the time and my work was often criticised.

- 5 **Really? You mean no-one liked your paintings?**

Yes! No-one wanted my paintings. I only sold one while I was alive. I couldn't do anything about whether or not my paintings sold. Some weeks I would go hungry because I spent the little money I had on art supplies instead. I believed that one day my paintings would be worth more than the cost of the paint and the struggle it took to create them.

- 7 **Wow! In our times, you are one of the most famous painters in history. Those paintings that no-one wanted are now worth millions of dollars. What do you think about your fame?**

I think that if I am worth something today then I was worth something then. I am thankful to my sister-in-law Jo who, despite being a single mother, worked tirelessly to promote my work.

- 9 **If you could be a colour, what would you be and why?**

- 10 I used colours to capture feelings rather than to represent what is actually real. When I was painting, I always thought how lovely yellow is! It stands for the sun, and to me, yellow embodies happiness.

The use of 'Wow!' emphasises that the interviewer feels

- ☐ disappointed.
- ☐ shocked.
- ☐ excited.
- ☐ curious.



Maybe you already know the name 'van Gogh' but do you know much about his paintings? Well, you can find out here in this 'interview'. But wait, you must be thinking, how can I interview someone who isn't alive? By using his letters to his brother Theo (and my own research, of course!), I imagined van Gogh's answers.

Quick facts

- **Name:** Vincent Willem van Gogh
- **Occupation:** artist, painter
- **Nationality:** Dutch
- **Born:** March 30, 1853, in Zundert, Netherlands
- **Died:** July 29, 1890, in Auvers-sur-Oise, France (aged 37)

Your paintings look like they're moving. How and why did you paint like this?

I wanted to capture everyday life and to express true human feeling. As a result, I hoped people would learn a new way of 'seeing'. When I painted a scene, I used swirly broken lines and bold brushstrokes to show movement as well as my feelings. However, this was not the 'normal' style of the time and my work was often criticised.

Really? You mean no-one liked your paintings?

Yes! No-one wanted my paintings. I only sold one while I was alive. I couldn't do anything about whether or not my paintings sold. Some weeks I would go hungry because I spent the little money I had on art supplies instead. I believed that one day my paintings would be worth more than the cost of the paint and the struggle it took to create them.

Wow! In our times, you are one of the most famous painters in history. Those paintings that no-one wanted are now worth millions of dollars. What do you think about your fame?

I think that if I am worth something today then I was worth something then. I am thankful to my sister-in-law Jo who, despite being a single mother, worked tirelessly to promote my work.

If you could be a colour, what would you be and why?

I used colours to capture feelings rather than to represent what is actually real. When I was painting, I always thought how lovely yellow is! It stands for the sun, and to me, yellow embodies happiness.

Text: © Jensen Solutions Pty Limited. Image: See acknowledgements.

According to the text, why is van Gogh thankful to his sister-in-law?

- ☐ She was able to sell some of his paintings.
- ☐ She worked hard to let people know about his paintings.
- ☐ She bought one of his paintings while he was alive.
- ☐ She stored his paintings after he died.



Maybe you already know the name 'van Gogh' but do you know much about his paintings? Well, you can find out here in this 'interview'. But wait, you must be thinking, how can I interview someone who isn't alive? By using his letters to his brother Theo (and my own research, of course!), I imagined van Gogh's answers.

Quick facts

- **Name:** Vincent Willem van Gogh
- **Occupation:** artist, painter
- **Nationality:** Dutch
- **Born:** March 30, 1853, in Zundert, Netherlands
- **Died:** July 29, 1890, in Auvers-sur-Oise, France (aged 37)

Your paintings look like they're moving. How and why did you paint like this?

I wanted to capture everyday life and to express true human feeling. As a result, I hoped people would learn a new way of 'seeing'. When I painted a scene, I used swirly broken lines and bold brushstrokes to show movement as well as my feelings. However, this was not the 'normal' style of the time and my work was often criticised.

Really? You mean no-one liked your paintings?

Yes! No-one wanted my paintings. I only sold one while I was alive. I couldn't do anything about whether or not my paintings sold. Some weeks I would go hungry because I spent the little money I had on art supplies instead. I believed that one day my paintings would be worth more than the cost of the paint and the struggle it took to create them.

Wow! In our times, you are one of the most famous painters in history. Those paintings that no-one wanted are now worth millions of dollars. What do you think about your fame?

I think that if I am worth something today then I was worth something then. I am thankful to my sister-in-law Jo who, despite being a single mother, worked tirelessly to promote my work.

If you could be a colour, what would you be and why?

I used colours to capture feelings rather than to represent what is actually real. When I was painting, I always thought how lovely yellow is! It stands for the sun, and to me, yellow embodies happiness.

Text: © Janson Solutions Pty Limited. Image: See acknowledgements.

What did van Gogh use to represent feelings in his paintings? Choose **two**.

- ☐ brushstrokes
- ☐ people
- ☐ scenery
- ☐ colour
- ☐ nature



1 Maybe you already know the name 'van Gogh' but do you know much about his paintings? Well, you can find out here in this 'interview'. But wait, you must be thinking, how can I interview someone who isn't alive? By using his letters to his brother Theo (and my own research, of course!), I imagined van Gogh's answers.

Quick facts

- **Name:** Vincent Willem van Gogh
- **Occupation:** artist, painter
- 2 • **Nationality:** Dutch
- **Born:** March 30, 1853, in Zundert, Netherlands
- **Died:** July 29, 1890, in Auvers-sur-Oise, France (aged 37)

3 **Your paintings look like they're moving. How and why did you paint like this?**

I wanted to capture everyday life and to express true human feeling. As a result, I hoped people would learn a new way of 'seeing'. When I painted a scene, I used swirly broken lines and bold brushstrokes to show movement as well as my feelings. However, this was not the 'normal' style of the time and my work was often criticised.

5 **Really? You mean no-one liked your paintings?**

Yes! No-one wanted my paintings. I only sold one while I was alive. I couldn't do anything about whether or not my paintings sold. Some weeks I would go hungry because I spent the little money I had on art supplies instead. I believed that one day my paintings would be worth more than the cost of the paint and the struggle it took to create them.

7 **Wow! In our times, you are one of the most famous painters in history. Those paintings that no-one wanted are now worth millions of dollars. What do you think about your fame?**

I think that if I am worth something today then I was worth something then. I am thankful to my sister-in-law Jo who, despite being a single mother, worked tirelessly to promote my work.

9 **If you could be a colour, what would you be and why?**

10 I used colours to capture feelings rather than to represent what is actually real. When I was painting, I always thought how lovely yellow is! It stands for the sun, and to me, yellow embodies happiness.

Text: © Jamboree Solutions Pty Limited. Image: See acknowledgements.

Which word from the text is closest in meaning to 'embodies' (paragraph 10)?

- ☐ 'create' (paragraph 6)
- ☐ 'worth' (paragraph 8)
- ☐ 'promote' (paragraph 8)
- ☐ 'represent' (paragraph 10)

THE PRIZE



1 Stella, Freya, Donny and Angelo did not normally sit near each other during assembly. But on this day, they found themselves drawn to each other, unwillingly but with the inexorable power of the magnetic force of the principal, Mrs Law. This was the morning the winner of the Willis Science Prize would be announced, and they knew they were the four finalists.

2 All the students knew today's assembly was special because two of their own were playing a duet on the piano on the side of the stage to welcome the teachers and interested parents who were taking their seats. The four small determined hands leapt over each other like plump spiders on the ivory keys—only the keys were not really made of ivory, were they, thought Stella. The world had progressed at least that much, although she had read somewhere that ivory hunters still existed. She looked at her feet, and tried not to think about elephants. The prize, the Willis Prize, soon she would know ...

3 Freya, on the other hand, was staring straight up, surveying the invisible constellations on the ceiling above her. She knew she would not get the prize. She had concluded early in her life that it was to be her luckless destiny never to touch the glittering crown that others treated so carelessly. All she wanted was for the assembly to be over, so she would no longer be at the mercy of her recalcitrant, ever-hopeful imagination.

4 Donny looked at the spot on the ceiling that Freya was focussed on and did not understand what it was that so fascinated her. He tapped his feet and drummed his fingers. Was assembly ever going to start? He put his head upside-down between his knees and wriggled his arms. Was this how sodium bicarbonate and citric acid atoms behaved when they were hit with water?

5 As for Angelo, he sat very still, his back straight as a mast. Not even his eyelids quivered. Yet, he was intensely aware of every sound, every movement. He could hear the blood being pumped from his heart to all parts of his body via his cardiovascular system and as the blood rushed to his head, he felt dizzy—was it excitement or fear? Or was it because Donny couldn't stop fidgeting?

6 Suddenly, chairs scraped and feet shuffled. Mrs Law was entering the hall from the back. She made her way down the aisle, clicking her heels, onwards up to the stage. The piano fell silent at last. Now! Now—they would know.

Text and images: © Jannet Solutions Pty Limited

The fact that Stella, Freya, Donny and Angelo were sitting together at assembly can be described as

- ☐ unusual.
- ☐ impractical.
- ☐ puzzling.
- ☐ distracting.

THE PRIZE



1 Stella, Freya, Donny and Angelo did not normally sit near each other during assembly. But on this day, they found themselves drawn to each other, unwillingly but with the **inexorable** power of the magnetic force of the principal, Mrs Law. This was the morning the winner of the Willis Science Prize would be announced, and they knew they were the four finalists.

2 All the students knew today's assembly was special because two of their own were playing a duet on the piano on the side of the stage to welcome the teachers and interested parents who were taking their seats. The four small determined hands leapt over each other like plump spiders on the ivory keys—only the keys were not really made of ivory, were they, thought Stella. The world had progressed at least that much, although she had read somewhere that ivory hunters still existed. She looked at her feet, and tried not to think about elephants. The prize, the Willis Prize, soon she would know ...

3 Freya, on the other hand, was staring straight up, surveying the invisible constellations on the ceiling above her. She knew she would not get the prize. She had concluded early in her life that it was to be her luckless destiny never to touch the glittering crown that others treated so carelessly. All she wanted was for the assembly to be over, so she would no longer be at the mercy of her recalcitrant, ever-hopeful imagination.

4 Donny looked at the spot on the ceiling that Freya was focussed on and did not understand what it was that so fascinated her. He tapped his feet and drummed his fingers. Was assembly ever going to start? He put his head upside-down between his knees and wriggled his arms. Was this how sodium bicarbonate and citric acid atoms behaved when they were hit with water?

5 As for Angelo, he sat very still, his back straight as a mast. Not even his eyelids quivered. Yet, he was intensely aware of every sound, every movement. He could hear the blood being pumped from his heart to all parts of his body via his cardiovascular system and as the blood rushed to his head, he felt dizzy—was it excitement or fear? Or was it because Donny couldn't stop fidgeting?

6 Suddenly, chairs scraped and feet shuffled. Mrs Law was entering the hall from the back. She made her way down the aisle, clicking her heels, onwards up to the stage. The piano fell silent at last. Now! Now—they would know.

Text and images © Simon Robinson (2013) Oxford

In the first paragraph, the word 'inexorable' means that the power of the magnetic force

- ☐ has been measured.
- ☐ is stronger than expected.
- ☐ is created by humans.
- ☐ cannot be stopped.



THE PRIZE



1 Stella, Freya, Donny and Angelo did not normally sit near each other during assembly. But on this day, they found themselves drawn to each other, unwillingly but with the inexorable power of the magnetic force of the principal, Mrs Law. This was the morning the winner of the Willis Science Prize would be announced, and they knew they were the four finalists.

2 All the students knew today's assembly was special because two of their own were playing a duet on the piano on the side of the stage to welcome the teachers and interested parents who were taking their seats. The four small determined hands leapt over each other like plump spiders on the ivory keys—only the keys were not really made of ivory, were they, thought Stella. The world had progressed at least that much, although she had read somewhere that ivory hunters still existed. She looked at her feet, and tried not to think about elephants. The prize, the Willis Prize, soon she would know ...

3 Freya, on the other hand, was staring straight up, surveying the invisible constellations on the ceiling above her. She knew she would not get the prize. She had concluded early in her life that it was to be her luckless destiny never to touch the glittering crown that others treated so carelessly. All she wanted was for the assembly to be over, so she would no longer be at the mercy of her recalcitrant, ever-hopeful imagination.

4 Donny looked at the spot on the ceiling that Freya was focussed on and did not understand what it was that so fascinated her. He tapped his feet and drummed his fingers. Was assembly ever going to start? He put his head upside-down between his knees and wriggled his arms. Was this how sodium bicarbonate and citric acid atoms behaved when they were hit with water?

5 As for Angelo, he sat very still, his back straight as a mast. Not even his eyelids quivered. Yet, he was intensely aware of every sound, every movement. He could hear the blood being pumped from his heart to all parts of his body via his cardiovascular system and as the blood rushed to his head, he felt dizzy—was it excitement or fear? Or was it because Donny couldn't stop fidgeting?

6 Suddenly, chairs scraped and feet shuffled. Mrs Law was entering the hall from the back. She made her way down the aisle, clicking her heels, onwards up to the stage. The piano fell silent at last. Now! Now—they would know.

Text and images: © Jemison Solutions Pty Limited

In the second paragraph, who does the phrase 'two of their own' refer to?

- ☐ Stella, Freya, Donny and Angelo's friends
- ☐ previous Willis Science Prize winners
- ☐ other students from the school
- ☐ fellow pianists



THE PRIZE



1 Stella, Freya, Donny and Angelo did not normally sit near each other during assembly. But on this day, they found themselves drawn to each other, unwillingly but with the inexorable power of the magnetic force of the principal, Mrs Law. This was the morning the winner of the Willis Science Prize would be announced, and they knew they were the four finalists.

2 All the students knew today's assembly was special because two of their own were playing a duet on the piano on the side of the stage to welcome the teachers and interested parents who were taking their seats. The four small determined hands leapt over each other like plump spiders on the ivory keys—only the keys were not really made of ivory, were they, thought Stella. The world had progressed at least that much, although she had read somewhere that ivory hunters still existed. She looked at her feet, and tried not to think about elephants. The prize, the Willis Prize, soon she would know ...

3 Freya, on the other hand, was staring straight up, surveying the invisible constellations on the ceiling above her. She knew she would not get the prize. She had concluded early in her life that it was to be her luckless destiny never to touch the glittering crown that others treated so carelessly. All she wanted was for the assembly to be over, so she would no longer be at the mercy of her recalcitrant, ever-hopeful imagination.

4 Donny looked at the spot on the ceiling that Freya was focussed on and did not understand what it was that so fascinated her. He tapped his feet and drummed his fingers. Was assembly ever going to start? He put his head upside-down between his knees and wriggled his arms. Was this how sodium bicarbonate and citric acid atoms behaved when they were hit with water?

5 As for Angelo, he sat very still, his back straight as a mast. Not even his eyelids quivered. Yet, he was intensely aware of every sound, every movement. He could hear the blood being pumped from his heart to all parts of his body via his cardiovascular system and as the blood rushed to his head, he felt dizzy—was it excitement or fear? Or was it because Donny couldn't stop fidgeting?

6 Suddenly, chairs scraped and feet shuffled. Mrs Law was entering the hall from the back. She made her way down the aisle, clicking her heels, onwards up to the stage. The piano fell silent at last. Now! Now—they would know.

Text and images © Jackson Solutions Pty Limited

Which statement best describes Freya's thoughts about winning the Willis Science Prize?

- ☐ She thinks the winner shouldn't be announced at assembly.
- ☐ She doesn't believe she will win but she can't help being hopeful.
- ☐ She is sure she won't win and wishes she had stayed at home.
- ☐ She thinks the prize is too important for her to be the winner.



THE PRIZE



1 Stella, Freya, Donny and Angelo did not normally sit near each other during assembly. But on this day, they found themselves drawn to each other, unwillingly but with the inexorable power of the magnetic force of the principal, Mrs Law. This was the morning the winner of the Willis Science Prize would be announced, and they knew they were the four finalists.

2 All the students knew today's assembly was special because two of their own were playing a duet on the piano on the side of the stage to welcome the teachers and interested parents who were taking their seats. The four small determined hands leapt over each other like plump spiders on the ivory keys—only the keys were not really made of ivory, were they, thought Stella. The world had progressed at least that much, although she had read somewhere that ivory hunters still existed. She looked at her feet, and tried not to think about elephants. The prize, the Willis Prize, soon she would know ...

3 Freya, on the other hand, was staring straight up, surveying the invisible constellations on the ceiling above her. She knew she would not get the prize. She had concluded early in her life that it was to be her luckless destiny never to touch the glittering crown that others treated so carelessly. All she wanted was for the assembly to be over, so she would no longer be at the mercy of her recalcitrant, ever-hopeful imagination.

4 Donny looked at the spot on the ceiling that Freya was focussed on and did not understand what it was that so fascinated her. He tapped his feet and drummed his fingers. Was assembly ever going to start? He put his head upside-down between his knees and wriggled his arms. Was this how sodium bicarbonate and citric acid atoms behaved when they were hit with water?

5 As for Angelo, he sat very still, his back straight as a mast. Not even his eyelids quivered. Yet, he was intensely aware of every sound, every movement. He could hear the blood being pumped from his heart to all parts of his body via his cardiovascular system and as the blood rushed to his head, he felt dizzy—was it excitement or fear? Or was it because Donny couldn't stop fidgeting?

6 Suddenly, chairs scraped and feet shuffled. Mrs Law was entering the hall from the back. She made her way down the aisle, clicking her heels, onwards up to the stage. The piano fell silent at last. Now! Now—they would know.

Text and images: © Jamison Solutions Pty Limited

In the third paragraph, which quotation describes a top or winning prize?

- ☐ 'the ceiling'
- ☐ 'luckless destiny'
- ☐ 'the glittering crown'
- ☐ 'ever-hopeful imagination'



THE PRIZE



1 Stella, Freya, Donny and Angelo did not normally sit near each other during assembly. But on this day, they found themselves drawn to each other, unwillingly but with the inexorable power of the magnetic force of the principal, Mrs Law. This was the morning the winner of the Willis Science Prize would be announced, and they knew they were the four finalists.

2 All the students knew today's assembly was special because two of their own were playing a duet on the piano on the side of the stage to welcome the teachers and interested parents who were taking their seats. The four small determined hands leapt over each other like plump spiders on the ivory keys—only the keys were not really made of ivory, were they, thought Stella. The world had progressed at least that much, although she had read somewhere that ivory hunters still existed. She looked at her feet, and tried not to think about elephants. The prize, the Willis Prize, soon she would know ...

3 Freya, on the other hand, was staring straight up, surveying the invisible constellations on the ceiling above her. She knew she would not get the prize. She had concluded early in her life that it was to be her luckless destiny never to touch the glittering crown that others treated so carelessly. All she wanted was for the assembly to be over, so she would no longer be at the mercy of her recalcitrant, ever-hopeful imagination.

4 Donny looked at the spot on the ceiling that Freya was focussed on and did not understand what it was that so fascinated her. He tapped his feet and drummed his fingers. Was assembly ever going to start? He put his head upside-down between his knees and wriggled his arms. Was this how sodium bicarbonate and citric acid atoms behaved when they were hit with water?

5 As for Angelo, he sat very still, his back straight as a mast. Not even his eyelids quivered. Yet, he was intensely aware of every sound, every movement. He could hear the blood being pumped from his heart to all parts of his body via his cardiovascular system and as the blood rushed to his head, he felt dizzy—was it excitement or fear? Or was it because Donny couldn't stop fidgeting?

6 Suddenly, chairs scraped and feet shuffled. Mrs Law was entering the hall from the back. She made her way down the aisle, clicking her heels, onwards up to the stage. The piano fell silent at last. Now! Now—they would know.

Text and images: © Jackson Solutions Pty Limited

Which word best describes how Angelo feels about Donny?

- ☐ irritated
- ☐ concerned
- ☐ protective
- ☐ disgusted



THE PRIZE



1 Stella, Freya, Donny and Angelo did not normally sit near each other during assembly. But on this day, they found themselves drawn to each other, unwillingly but with the inexorable power of the magnetic force of the principal, Mrs Law. This was the morning the winner of the Willis Science Prize would be announced, and they knew they were the four finalists.

2 All the students knew today's assembly was special because two of their own were playing a duet on the piano on the side of the stage to welcome the teachers and interested parents who were taking their seats. The four small determined hands leapt over each other like plump spiders on the ivory keys—only the keys were not really made of ivory, were they, thought Stella. The world had progressed at least that much, although she had read somewhere that ivory hunters still existed. She looked at her feet, and tried not to think about elephants. The prize, the Willis Prize, soon she would know ...

3 Freya, on the other hand, was staring straight up, surveying the invisible constellations on the ceiling above her. She knew she would not get the prize. She had concluded early in her life that it was to be her luckless destiny never to touch the glittering crown that others treated so carelessly. All she wanted was for the assembly to be over, so she would no longer be at the mercy of her recalcitrant, ever-hopeful imagination.

4 Donny looked at the spot on the ceiling that Freya was focussed on and did not understand what it was that so fascinated her. He tapped his feet and drummed his fingers. Was assembly ever going to start? He put his head upside-down between his knees and wriggled his arms. Was this how sodium bicarbonate and citric acid atoms behaved when they were hit with water?

5 As for Angelo, he sat very still, his back straight as a mast. Not even his eyelids quivered. Yet, he was intensely aware of every sound, every movement. He could hear the blood being pumped from his heart to all parts of his body via his cardiovascular system and as the blood rushed to his head, he felt dizzy—was it excitement or fear? Or was it because Donny couldn't stop fidgeting?

6 Suddenly, chairs scraped and feet shuffled. Mrs Law was entering the hall from the back. She made her way down the aisle, clicking her heels, onwards up to the stage. The piano fell silent at last. Now! Now—they would know.

Text and images: © Jamison Solutions Pty Limited

The descriptions of Stella, Freya, Donny and Angelo show that they are interested in different areas of science. Match them with their area of interest.

stars and planets	the human body
animals	chemicals
Stella	
Freya	
Donny	
Angelo	



Active kids learn better



1 Do active kids learn better? Canadian researcher Dr Rachel Colley thinks so. She believes that students in active schools can improve not only their grades, but also their attention in class, thinking skills, and general health simply by exercising more often. And she is not the only one to come to this conclusion.

2 Active schools are so called because they deliberately include physical activity as part of their school day. I observed a class in one such school. Students were about to change to a different subject when the teacher, Mr Robertson, used a few prompts that were obviously part of the classroom routine. The students quickly assembled by the door. 'How long, Mr Robertson?' they chorused happily. Mr Robertson consulted the class fitness chart for the week and replied, 'Five minutes of running on the athletics field.' And off they went, without fuss.

3 Teachers in active schools explained that they often joined in the exercises, encouraging students who needed a prod to keep going, and helping all to set their own running goals. So what did Mr Robertson and his colleagues expect from this? The teachers said that in the short term, students demonstrated more on-task time, more energy for learning, more confidence and less misbehaviour. In the long term, they hoped for healthy, happy children who worked hard to achieve learning goals.



Question 32 of 45

3 teachers in active schools explained that they often joined in the exercises, encouraging students who needed a prod to keep going, and helping all to set their own running goals. So what did Mr Robertson and his colleagues expect from this? The teachers said that in the short term, students demonstrated more on-task time, more energy for learning, more confidence and less misbehaviour. In the long term, they hoped for healthy, happy children who worked hard to achieve learning goals.

4 Dr Colley would agree. In fact, the research is so compelling that in 2005, the government of Ontario, Canada, required schools to include at least 20 minutes of physical activity every day. More recent research continues to support this link between physical activity and academic performance. A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.

5 But what if it's not convenient to go outside? Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane? A 2016 study of students in grades 2 and 3 in 12 schools in the Netherlands actually did something like that. The researchers developed a program called *Fit & Vaardig op School* (Fit and Academically Proficient at School) which used physical exercise to teach mathematics and language. For example, students hopped 8 times to solve '2 x 4'. They found that after two school years, the active students gained four months of learning over the students in traditional classrooms in speed mathematics, mathematics skills and spelling.

6 Sometimes simple solutions yield great results.

Text © Janison Solutions Pty Limited. Image: See acknowledgements.

What does the word 'compelling' mean?

- ☐ trustworthy
- ☐ convincing
- ☐ new
- ☐ accurate

◀ Back

Flag

Next ▶

Active kids learn better



1 Do active kids learn better? Canadian researcher Dr Rachel Colley thinks so. She believes that students in active schools can improve not only their grades, but also their attention in class, thinking skills, and general health simply by exercising more often. And she is not the only one to come to this conclusion.

2 Active schools are so called because they deliberately include physical activity as part of their school day. I observed a class in one such school. Students were about to change to a different subject when the teacher, Mr Robertson, used a few prompts that were obviously part of the classroom routine. The students quickly assembled by the door. 'How long, Mr Robertson?' they chorused happily. Mr Robertson consulted the class fitness chart for the week and replied, 'Five minutes of running on the athletics field.' And off they went, without fuss.

3 Teachers in active schools explained that they often joined in the exercises, encouraging students who needed a prod to keep going, and helping all to set their own running goals. So what did Mr Robertson and his colleagues expect from this? The teachers said that in the short term, students demonstrated more on-task time, more energy for learning, more confidence and less misbehaviour. In the long term, they hoped for healthy, happy children who worked hard to achieve learning goals.

4 Dr Colley would agree. In fact, the research is so compelling that in 2005, the government of Ontario, Canada, required schools to include at least 20 minutes of physical activity every day. More recent research continues to support this link between physical activity and academic performance. A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.

5 But what if it's not convenient to go outside? Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane? A 2016 study of students in grades 2 and 3 in 12 schools in the Netherlands actually did something like that. The researchers developed a program called *Fit & Vaardig op School* (Fit and Academically Proficient at School) which used physical exercise to teach mathematics and language. For example, students hopped 8 times to solve '2 x 4'. They found that after two school years, the active students gained four months of learning over the students in traditional classrooms in speed mathematics, mathematics skills and spelling.

6 Sometimes simple solutions yield great results.

What does the word 'compelling' mean?

- ☐ trustworthy
- ☐ convincing
- ☐ new
- ☐ accurate

Active kids learn better



Do active kids learn better? Canadian researcher Dr Rachel Colley thinks so. She believes that students in active schools can improve not only their grades, but also their attention in class, thinking skills, and general health simply by exercising more often. And she is not the only one to come to this conclusion.

Active schools are so called because they deliberately include physical activity as part of their school day. I observed a class in one such school. Students were about to change to a different subject when the teacher, Mr Robertson, used a few prompts that were obviously part of the classroom routine. The students quickly assembled by the door. 'How long, Mr Robertson?' they chorused happily. Mr Robertson consulted the class fitness chart for the week and replied, 'Five minutes of running on the athletics field.' And off they went, without fuss.

Teachers in active schools explained that they often joined in the exercises, encouraging students who needed a prod to keep going, and helping all to set their own running goals. So what did Mr Robertson and his colleagues expect from this? The teachers said that in the short term, students demonstrated more on-task time, more energy for learning, more confidence and less misbehaviour. In the long term, they hoped for healthy, happy children who worked hard to achieve learning goals.

Dr Colley would agree. In fact, the research is so compelling that in 2005, the government of Ontario, Canada, required schools to include at least 20 minutes of physical activity every day. More recent research continues to support this link between physical activity and academic performance. A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.

But what if it's not convenient to go outside? Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane? A 2016 study of students in grades 2 and 3 in 12 schools in the Netherlands actually did something like that. The researchers developed a program called *Fit & Vaardig op School* (Fit and Academically Proficient at School) which used physical exercise to teach mathematics and language. For example, students hopped 8 times to solve '2 x 4'. They found that after two school years, the active students gained four months of learning over the students in traditional classrooms in speed mathematics, mathematics skills and spelling.

Sometimes simple solutions yield great results.

'A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.'

Which of the following could be placed in front of the sentence so that it links it to the rest of the paragraph?

- ☐ Therefore,
- ☐ Finally,
- ☐ In addition,
- ☐ For example,

Active kids learn better



1 Do active kids learn better? Canadian researcher Dr Rachel Colley thinks so. She believes that students in active schools can improve not only their grades, but also their attention in class, thinking skills, and general health simply by exercising more often. And she is not the only one to come to this conclusion.

2 Active schools are so called because they deliberately include physical activity as part of their school day. I observed a class in one such school. Students were about to change to a different subject when the teacher, Mr Robertson, used a few prompts that were obviously part of the classroom routine. The students quickly assembled by the door. 'How long, Mr Robertson?' they chorused happily. Mr Robertson consulted the class fitness chart for the week and replied, 'Five minutes of running on the athletics field.' And off they went, without fuss.

3 Teachers in active schools explained that they often joined in the exercises, encouraging students who needed a prod to keep going, and helping all to set their own running goals. So what did Mr Robertson and his colleagues expect from this? The teachers said that in the short term, students demonstrated more on-task time, more energy for learning, more confidence and less misbehaviour. In the long term, they hoped for healthy, happy children who worked hard to achieve learning goals.

4 Dr Colley would agree. In fact, the research is so compelling that in 2005, the government of Ontario, Canada, required schools to include at least 20 minutes of physical activity every day. More recent research continues to support this link between physical activity and academic performance. A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.

5 But what if it's not convenient to go outside? Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane? A 2016 study of students in grades 2 and 3 in 12 schools in the Netherlands actually did something like that. The researchers developed a program called *Fit & Vaardig op School* (Fit and Academically Proficient at School) which used physical exercise to teach mathematics and language. For example, students hopped 8 times to solve '2 x 4'. They found that after two school years, the active students gained four months of learning over the students in traditional classrooms in speed mathematics, mathematics skills and spelling.

6 Sometimes simple solutions yield great results.

'Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane?'

What is unusual about the tone of the sentence?

- ☐ The writer seems like she is interested in the topic but is actually not.
- ☐ The writer seems like she is praising the idea but is actually criticising it.
- ☐ The writer sounds like she has made up her mind but is actually undecided.
- ☐ The writer sounds like she is joking about the idea but is actually serious.

Active kids learn better



1 Do active kids learn better? Canadian researcher Dr Rachel Colley thinks so. She believes that students in active schools can improve not only their grades, but also their attention in class, thinking skills, and general health simply by exercising more often. And she is not the only one to come to this conclusion.

2 Active schools are so called because they deliberately include physical activity as part of their school day. I observed a class in one such school. Students were about to change to a different subject when the teacher, Mr Robertson, used a few prompts that were obviously part of the classroom routine. The students quickly assembled by the door. 'How long, Mr Robertson?' they chorused happily. Mr Robertson consulted the class fitness chart for the week and replied, 'Five minutes of running on the athletics field.' And off they went, without fuss.

3 Teachers in active schools explained that they often joined in the exercises, encouraging students who needed a prod to keep going, and helping all to set their own running goals. So what did Mr Robertson and his colleagues expect from this? The teachers said that in the short term, students demonstrated more on-task time, more energy for learning, more confidence and less misbehaviour. In the long term, they hoped for healthy, happy children who worked hard to achieve learning goals.

4 Dr Colley would agree. In fact, the research is so compelling that in 2005, the government of Ontario, Canada, required schools to include at least 20 minutes of physical activity every day. More recent research continues to support this link between physical activity and academic performance. A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.

5 But what if it's not convenient to go outside? Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane? A 2016 study of students in grades 2 and 3 in 12 schools in the Netherlands actually did something like that. The researchers developed a program called *Fit & Vaardig op School* (Fit and Academically Proficient at School) which used physical exercise to teach mathematics and language. For example, students hopped 8 times to solve '2 x 4'. They found that after two school years, the active students gained four months of learning over the students in traditional classrooms in speed mathematics, mathematics skills and spelling.

6 Sometimes simple solutions yield great results.

How is the *Fit & Vaardig op School* program different from other active school programs?

- ☐ Students must use the program for two years.
- ☐ There are more than 10 schools involved.
- ☐ Students learn through exercise.
- ☐ The students are in primary school.

Active kids learn better



1 Do active kids learn better? Canadian researcher Dr Rachel Colley thinks so. She believes that students in active schools can improve not only their grades, but also their attention in class, thinking skills, and general health simply by exercising more often. And she is not the only one to come to this conclusion.

2 Active schools are so called because they deliberately include physical activity as part of their school day. I observed a class in one such school. Students were about to change to a different subject when the teacher, Mr Robertson, used a few prompts that were obviously part of the classroom routine. The students quickly assembled by the door. 'How long, Mr Robertson?' they chorused happily. Mr Robertson consulted the class fitness chart for the week and replied, 'Five minutes of running on the athletics field.' And off they went, without fuss.

3 Teachers in active schools explained that they often joined in the exercises, encouraging students who needed a prod to keep going, and helping all to set their own running goals. So what did Mr Robertson and his colleagues expect from this? The teachers said that in the short term, students demonstrated more on-task time, more energy for learning, more confidence and less misbehaviour. In the long term, they hoped for healthy, happy children who worked hard to achieve learning goals.

4 Dr Colley would agree. In fact, the research is so compelling that in 2005, the government of Ontario, Canada, required schools to include at least 20 minutes of physical activity every day. More recent research continues to support this link between physical activity and academic performance. A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.

5 But what if it's not convenient to go outside? Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane? A 2016 study of students in grades 2 and 3 in 12 schools in the Netherlands actually did something like that. The researchers developed a program called *Fit & Vaardig op School* (Fit and Academically Proficient at School) which used physical exercise to teach mathematics and language. For example, students hopped 8 times to solve '2 x 4'. They found that after two school years, the active students gained four months of learning over the students in traditional classrooms in speed mathematics, mathematics skills and spelling.

6 Sometimes simple solutions yield great results.

The last paragraph only has one sentence. The text ends with a short paragraph because

- ☐ the writer wants to emphasise the statement.
- ☐ the writer has run out of ideas.
- ☐ the writer wants to prove the program works.
- ☐ the writer wants to create a sense of urgency.



Active kids learn better



1 Do active kids learn better? Canadian researcher Dr Rachel Colley thinks so. She believes that students in active schools can improve not only their grades, but also their attention in class, thinking skills, and general health simply by exercising more often. And she is not the only one to come to this conclusion.

2 Active schools are so called because they deliberately include physical activity as part of their school day. I observed a class in one such school. Students were about to change to a different subject when the teacher, Mr Robertson, used a few prompts that were obviously part of the classroom routine. The students quickly assembled by the door. 'How long, Mr Robertson?' they chorused happily. Mr Robertson consulted the class fitness chart for the week and replied, 'Five minutes of running on the athletics field.' And off they went, without fuss.

3 Teachers in active schools explained that they often joined in the exercises, encouraging students who needed a prod to keep going, and helping all to set their own running goals. So what did Mr Robertson and his colleagues expect from this? The teachers said that in the short term, students demonstrated more on-task time, more energy for learning, more confidence and less misbehaviour. In the long term, they hoped for healthy, happy children who worked hard to achieve learning goals.

4 Dr Colley would agree. In fact, the research is so compelling that in 2005, the government of Ontario, Canada, required schools to include at least 20 minutes of physical activity every day. More recent research continues to support this link between physical activity and academic performance. A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.

5 But what if it's not convenient to go outside? Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane? A 2016 study of students in grades 2 and 3 in 12 schools in the Netherlands actually did something like that. The researchers developed a program called *Fit & Vaardig op School* (Fit and Academically Proficient at School) which used physical exercise to teach mathematics and language. For example, students hopped 8 times to solve '2 x 4'. They found that after two school years, the active students gained four months of learning over the students in traditional classrooms in speed mathematics, mathematics skills and spelling.

6 Sometimes simple solutions yield great results.

Which piece of evidence from the text best supports the idea that active schools are effective?

- ☐ that Mr Robertson included physical activity in his class
- ☐ that Dr Rachel Colley believes that active schools help students to learn
- ☐ that active students gained four months of learning over students in traditional classrooms
- ☐ that teachers were willing to join their students in exercising

Active kids learn better



1 Do active kids learn better? Canadian researcher Dr Rachel Colley thinks so. She believes that students in active schools can improve not only their grades, but also their attention in class, thinking skills, and general health simply by exercising more often. And she is not the only one to come to this conclusion.

2 Active schools are so called because they deliberately include physical activity as part of their school day. I observed a class in one such school. Students were about to change to a different subject when the teacher, Mr Robertson, used a few prompts that were obviously part of the classroom routine. The students quickly assembled by the door. 'How long, Mr Robertson?' they chorused happily. Mr Robertson consulted the class fitness chart for the week and replied, 'Five minutes of running on the athletics field.' And off they went, without fuss.

3 Teachers in active schools explained that they often joined in the exercises, encouraging students who needed a prod to keep going, and helping all to set their own running goals. So what did Mr Robertson and his colleagues expect from this? The teachers said that in the short term, students demonstrated more on-task time, more energy for learning, more confidence and less misbehaviour. In the long term, they hoped for healthy, happy children who worked hard to achieve learning goals.

4 Dr Colley would agree. In fact, the research is so compelling that in 2005, the government of Ontario, Canada, required schools to include at least 20 minutes of physical activity every day. More recent research continues to support this link between physical activity and academic performance. A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.

5 But what if it's not convenient to go outside? Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane? A 2016 study of students in grades 2 and 3 in 12 schools in the Netherlands actually did something like that. The researchers developed a program called *Fit & Vaardig op School* (Fit and Academically Proficient at School) which used physical exercise to teach mathematics and language. For example, students hopped 8 times to solve '2 x 4'. They found that after two school years, the active students gained four months of learning over the students in traditional classrooms in speed mathematics, mathematics skills and spelling.

6 Sometimes simple solutions yield great results.

What is the main purpose of the text?

- ☐ to encourage teachers to become more active
- ☐ to stress the importance of improving maths and English scores
- ☐ to give examples of fitness activities for students
- ☐ to persuade schools to include physical activity every day

The logo for 'Tree girl' features the words 'Tree girl' in a green, rounded font. The word 'Tree' is larger and more prominent. On either side of the text are green, stylized illustrations of a girl's head and shoulders, appearing to be part of the tree's foliage.

1 I caught a glimpse of her, way up amongst the greenery, sun-dappled legs and feet dangling through the lower foliage. I could see her watching me, her eyes digging into me, boastful and intense, while at the same time eager and a little bit teasing. She was high up in the giant fig. Her gaze challenged me to stop and join her.

2 I stumbled up onto one of the massive surface roots that radiated out from the trunk and boosted myself towards a low branch that was now almost in reach but I stopped when leaves rustled loudly above. In a breath, the dangling feet were gone, replaced by an upturned mop of curly hair and two swaying arms. A moment later, the arms swung up and grabbed my aimed-for branch. The rest of her followed in an effortless arc and with a quick flip sideways, she was seated facing me on her new perch.

3 I'd first met the tree girl when I was frantically tracking Charlie's escape into a tall eucalypt. She'd claimed to be able to think like a bird, and when I had asked her what that meant, she'd just stared at me. I'd felt as if she was sizing me up, faults and all. It had made me uncomfortable. But instead of speaking, she had looked towards the ground and smiled. Now she looked down at me, grinning.

4 Climbing again, I made it to the first branch but she scrambled higher into the tree, jumping from branch to branch as if falling was never an option. Gravity did not seem to apply to her. I dropped back to the ground so I could better watch how she moved through the tree, surely, fearlessly, as a bird would move. I felt my body could never be that relaxed and agile.

5 I really didn't want to ask, but I found myself shouting up into the leaves: 'I've been looking for you all week. How do you do that?' She was balancing casually on a high branch, but she descended quickly with the same careless grace before jumping down from the tree like a knight might have leapt from his horse after a victory in battle.

6 Eye to eye now, she shrugged her shoulders at me. 'My big brother climbed trees, so I did too.'

7 'Then I wish I'd had a big brother!' I replied but worried whether I should have said it. 'Anyway, I'd better go. I just wanted to thank you for rescuing Charlie. I owe you.'

8 'Nah, that's okay, Jack. I was in the tree anyway,' she said with a grin.

9 I watched her go, wondering if she moved like an animal on the ground too. She walked away, arms swinging. I strode in the opposite direction, swinging my arms as if to propel myself into the future.

Text and image: © Janssen Solutions Pty Limited

Which word in the sentence is closest in meaning to 'digging into me'?

I could see her watching me, her eyes digging into me, boastful and intense, while at the same time eager and a little bit teasing.

The logo features the words "Tree girl" in a green, rounded font. To the left of the text is a green silhouette of a tree with a girl figure inside it, and to the right is a green silhouette of a girl figure with a tree inside her.

1 I caught a glimpse of her, way up amongst the greenery, sun-dappled legs and feet dangling through the lower foliage. I could see her watching me, her eyes digging into me, boastful and intense, while at the same time eager and a little bit teasing. She was high up in the giant fig. Her gaze challenged me to stop and join her.

2 I stumbled up onto one of the massive surface roots that radiated out from the trunk and boosted myself towards a low branch that was now almost in reach but I stopped when leaves rustled loudly above. In a breath, the dangling feet were gone, replaced by an upturned mop of curly hair and two swaying arms. A moment later, the arms swung up and grabbed my aimed-for branch. The rest of her followed in an effortless arc and with a quick flip sideways, she was seated facing me on her new perch.

3 I'd first met the tree girl when I was frantically tracking Charlie's escape into a tall eucalypt. She'd claimed to be able to think like a bird, and when I had asked her what that meant, she'd just stared at me. I'd felt as if she was sizing me up, faults and all. It had made me uncomfortable. But instead of speaking, she had looked towards the ground and smiled. Now she looked down at me, grinning.

4 Climbing again, I made it to the first branch but she scrambled higher into the tree, jumping from branch to branch as if falling was never an option. Gravity did not seem to apply to her. I dropped back to the ground so I could better watch how she moved through the tree, surely, fearlessly, as a bird would move. I felt my body could never be that relaxed and agile.

5 I really didn't want to ask, but I found myself shouting up into the leaves: 'I've been looking for you all week. How do you do that?' She was balancing casually on a high branch, but she descended quickly with the same careless grace before jumping down from the tree like a knight might have leapt from his horse after a victory in battle.

6 Eye to eye now, she shrugged her shoulders at me. 'My big brother climbed trees, so I did too.'

7 'Then I wish I'd had a big brother!' I replied but worried whether I should have said it. 'Anyway, I'd better go. I just wanted to thank you for rescuing Charlie. I owe you.'

8 'Nah, that's okay, Jack. I was in the tree anyway,' she said with a grin.

9 I watched her go, wondering if she moved like an animal on the ground too. She walked away, arms swinging. I strode in the opposite direction, swinging my arms as if to propel myself into the future.

Text and images: © Janine Solutions Pty Limited

'She'd claimed to be able to think like a bird' (paragraph 3)

When Jack wanted to know what she meant by her claim, the girl

- ☐ behaved as if the answer was obvious.
- ☐ smiled because she wanted to keep it a secret.
- ☐ ignored him as she did not trust him.
- ☐ glared at him because she had misunderstood him.

The logo for 'Tree girl' features the title in a green, rounded font. On either side of the text are stylized green leaves or branches.

1 I caught a glimpse of her, way up amongst the greenery, sun-dappled legs and feet dangling through the lower foliage. I could see her watching me, her eyes digging into me, boastful and intense, while at the same time eager and a little bit teasing. She was high up in the giant fig. Her gaze challenged me to stop and join her.

2 I stumbled up onto one of the massive surface roots that radiated out from the trunk and boosted myself towards a low branch that was now almost in reach but I stopped when leaves rustled loudly above. In a breath, the dangling feet were gone, replaced by an upturned mop of curly hair and two swaying arms. A moment later, the arms swung up and grabbed my aimed-for branch. The rest of her followed in an effortless arc and with a quick flip sideways, she was seated facing me on her new perch.

3 I'd first met the tree girl when I was frantically tracking Charlie's escape into a tall eucalypt. She'd claimed to be able to think like a bird, and when I had asked her what that meant, she'd just stared at me. I'd felt as if she was sizing me up, faults and all. It had made me uncomfortable. But instead of speaking, she had looked towards the ground and smiled. Now she looked down at me, grinning.

4 Climbing again, I made it to the first branch but she scrambled higher into the tree, jumping from branch to branch as if falling was never an option. Gravity did not seem to apply to her. I dropped back to the ground so I could better watch how she moved through the tree, surely, fearlessly, as a bird would move. I felt my body could never be that relaxed and agile.

5 I really didn't want to ask, but I found myself shouting up into the leaves: 'I've been looking for you all week. How do you do that?' She was balancing casually on a high branch, but she descended quickly with the same careless grace before jumping down from the tree like a knight might have leapt from his horse after a victory in battle.

6 Eye to eye now, she shrugged her shoulders at me. 'My big brother climbed trees, so I did too.'

7 'Then I wish I'd had a big brother!' I replied but worried whether I should have said it. 'Anyway, I'd better go. I just wanted to thank you for rescuing Charlie. I owe you.'

8 'Nah, that's okay, Jack. I was in the tree anyway,' she said with a grin.

9 I watched her go, wondering if she moved like an animal on the ground too. She walked away, arms swinging. I strode in the opposite direction, swinging my arms as if to propel myself into the future.

Text and images: © Janssen Solutions Pty Limited

In the third paragraph in the sentence 'It had made me uncomfortable', the word 'It' refers to

- ☐ one of Jack's faults.
- ☐ the girl's look.
- ☐ the girl's skill.
- ☐ being scared for the girl's safety.

The logo for 'Tree girl' features the text 'Tree girl' in a green, rounded font. To the left of the text is a green tree icon, and to the right is a green girl icon with curly hair.

1 I caught a glimpse of her, way up amongst the greenery, sun-dappled legs and feet dangling through the lower foliage. I could see her watching me, her eyes digging into me, boastful and intense, while at the same time eager and a little bit teasing. She was high up in the giant fig. Her gaze challenged me to stop and join her.

2 I stumbled up onto one of the massive surface roots that radiated out from the trunk and boosted myself towards a low branch that was now almost in reach but I stopped when leaves rustled loudly above. In a breath, the dangling feet were gone, replaced by an upturned mop of curly hair and two swaying arms. A moment later, the arms swung up and grabbed my aimed-for branch. The rest of her followed in an effortless arc and with a quick flip sideways, she was seated facing me on her new perch.

3 I'd first met the tree girl when I was frantically tracking Charlie's escape into a tall eucalypt. She'd claimed to be able to think like a bird, and when I had asked her what that meant, she'd just stared at me. I'd felt as if she was sizing me up, faults and all. It had made me uncomfortable. But instead of speaking, she had looked towards the ground and smiled. Now she looked down at me, grinning.

4 Climbing again, I made it to the first branch but she scrambled higher into the tree, jumping from branch to branch as if falling was never an option. Gravity did not seem to apply to her. I dropped back to the ground so I could better watch how she moved through the tree, surely, fearlessly, as a bird would move. I felt my body could never be that relaxed and agile.

5 I really didn't want to ask, but I found myself shouting up into the leaves: 'I've been looking for you all week. How do you do that?' She was balancing casually on a high branch, but she descended quickly with the same careless grace before jumping down from the tree like a knight might have leapt from his horse after a victory in battle.

6 Eye to eye now, she shrugged her shoulders at me. 'My big brother climbed trees, so I did too.'

7 'Then I wish I'd had a big brother!' I replied but worried whether I should have said it. 'Anyway, I'd better go. I just wanted to thank you for rescuing Charlie. I owe you.'

8 'Nah, that's okay, Jack. I was in the tree anyway,' she said with a grin.

9 I watched her go, wondering if she moved like an animal on the ground too. She walked away, arms swinging. I strode in the opposite direction, swinging my arms as if to propel myself into the future.

Text and images © Jannan Sullivan Pty Limited

The writer uses the simile 'like a knight might have leapt from his horse after a victory in battle' to show that the girl was

- ☐ making fun of Jack.
- ☐ pleased with her efforts.
- ☐ related to royalty.
- ☐ willing to take risks.

The logo features the words "Tree girl" in a green, rounded font. To the left of the text is a green leafy branch, and to the right is a green silhouette of a girl climbing a tree.

1 I caught a glimpse of her, way up amongst the greenery, sun-dappled legs and feet dangling through the lower foliage. I could see her watching me, her eyes digging into me, boastful and intense, while at the same time eager and a little bit teasing. She was high up in the giant fig. Her gaze challenged me to stop and join her.

2 I stumbled up onto one of the massive surface roots that radiated out from the trunk and boosted myself towards a low branch that was now almost in reach but I stopped when leaves rustled loudly above. In a breath, the dangling feet were gone, replaced by an upturned mop of curly hair and two swaying arms. A moment later, the arms swung up and grabbed my aimed-for branch. The rest of her followed in an effortless arc and with a quick flip sideways, she was seated facing me on her new perch.

3 I'd first met the tree girl when I was frantically tracking Charlie's escape into a tall eucalypt. She'd claimed to be able to think like a bird, and when I had asked her what that meant, she'd just stared at me. I'd felt as if she was sizing me up, faults and all. It had made me uncomfortable. But instead of speaking, she had looked towards the ground and smiled. Now she looked down at me, grinning.

4 Climbing again, I made it to the first branch but she scrambled higher into the tree, jumping from branch to branch as if falling was never an option. Gravity did not seem to apply to her. I dropped back to the ground so I could better watch how she moved through the tree, surely, fearlessly, as a bird would move. I felt my body could never be that relaxed and agile.

5 I really didn't want to ask, but I found myself shouting up into the leaves: 'I've been looking for you all week. How do you do that?' She was balancing casually on a high branch, but she descended quickly with the same careless grace before jumping down from the tree like a knight might have leapt from his horse after a victory in battle.

6 Eye to eye now, she shrugged her shoulders at me. 'My big brother climbed trees, so I did too.'

7 'Then I wish I'd had a big brother!' I replied but worried whether I should have said it. 'Anyway, I'd better go. I just wanted to thank you for rescuing Charlie. I owe you.'

8 'Nah, that's okay, Jack. I was in the tree anyway,' she said with a grin.

9 I watched her go, wondering if she moved like an animal on the ground too. She walked away, arms swinging. I strode in the opposite direction, swinging my arms as if to propel myself into the future.

Text and image: © Jamieson Solutions Pty Limited

How did Jack and the girl know each other?

- ☐ The girl had found Jack's pet.
- ☐ Jack had seen her swinging in the trees.
- ☐ The girl was going to teach Jack some swinging skills.
- ☐ Jack had been looking for the girl.



Tree girl

1 I caught a glimpse of her, way up amongst the greenery, sun-dappled legs and feet dangling through the lower foliage. I could see her watching me, her eyes digging into me, boastful and intense, while at the same time eager and a little bit teasing. She was high up in the giant fig. Her gaze challenged me to stop and join her.

2 I stumbled up onto one of the massive surface roots that radiated out from the trunk and boosted myself towards a low branch that was now almost in reach but I stopped when leaves rustled loudly above. In a breath, the dangling feet were gone, replaced by an upturned mop of curly hair and two swaying arms. A moment later, the arms swung up and grabbed my aimed-for branch. The rest of her followed in an effortless arc and with a quick flip sideways, she was seated facing me on her new perch.

3 I'd first met the tree girl when I was frantically tracking Charlie's escape into a tall eucalypt. She'd claimed to be able to think like a bird, and when I had asked her what that meant, she'd just stared at me. I'd felt as if she was sizing me up, faults and all. It had made me uncomfortable. But instead of speaking, she had looked towards the ground and smiled. Now she looked down at me, grinning.

4 Climbing again, I made it to the first branch but she scrambled higher into the tree, jumping from branch to branch as if falling was never an option. Gravity did not seem to apply to her. I dropped back to the ground so I could better watch how she moved through the tree, surely, fearlessly, as a bird would move. I felt my body could never be that relaxed and agile.

5 I really didn't want to ask, but I found myself shouting up into the leaves: 'I've been looking for you all week. How do you do that?' She was balancing casually on a high branch, but she descended quickly with the same careless grace before jumping down from the tree like a knight might have leapt from his horse after a victory in battle.

6 Eye to eye now, she shrugged her shoulders at me. 'My big brother climbed trees, so I did too.'

7 'Then I wish I'd had a big brother!' I replied but worried whether I should have said it. 'Anyway, I'd better go. I just wanted to thank you for rescuing Charlie. I owe you.'

8 'Nah, that's okay, Jack. I was in the tree anyway,' she said with a grin.

9 I watched her go, wondering if she moved like an animal on the ground too. She walked away, arms swinging. I strode in the opposite direction, swinging my arms as if to propel myself into the future.

Text and images: © Jantzen Solutions Pty Limited

In the final paragraph, Jack's attitude towards the girl could be described as

- ☐ distrust.
- ☐ tolerance.
- ☐ sympathy.
- ☐ admiration.

The logo for 'Tree girl' features the words 'Tree girl' in a green, rounded font. The word 'Tree' is larger and more prominent. On either side of the text are stylized green leaves or branches.

1 I caught a glimpse of her, way up amongst the greenery, sun-dappled legs and feet dangling through the lower foliage. I could see her watching me, her eyes digging into me, boastful and intense, while at the same time eager and a little bit teasing. She was high up in the giant fig. Her gaze challenged me to stop and join her.

2 I stumbled up onto one of the massive surface roots that radiated out from the trunk and boosted myself towards a low branch that was now almost in reach but I stopped when leaves rustled loudly above. In a breath, the dangling feet were gone, replaced by an upturned mop of curly hair and two swaying arms. A moment later, the arms swung up and grabbed my aimed-for branch. The rest of her followed in an effortless arc and with a quick flip sideways, she was seated facing me on her new perch.

3 I'd first met the tree girl when I was frantically tracking Charlie's escape into a tall eucalypt. She'd claimed to be able to think like a bird, and when I had asked her what that meant, she'd just stared at me. I'd felt as if she was sizing me up, faults and all. It had made me uncomfortable. But instead of speaking, she had looked towards the ground and smiled. Now she looked down at me, grinning.

4 Climbing again, I made it to the first branch but she scrambled higher into the tree, jumping from branch to branch as if falling was never an option. Gravity did not seem to apply to her. I dropped back to the ground so I could better watch how she moved through the tree, surely, fearlessly, as a bird would move. I felt my body could never be that relaxed and agile.

5 I really didn't want to ask, but I found myself shouting up into the leaves: 'I've been looking for you all week. How do you do that?' She was balancing casually on a high branch, but she descended quickly with the same careless grace before jumping down from the tree like a knight might have leapt from his horse after a victory in battle.

6 Eye to eye now, she shrugged her shoulders at me. 'My big brother climbed trees, so I did too.'

7 'Then I wish I'd had a big brother!' I replied but worried whether I should have said it. 'Anyway, I'd better go. I just wanted to thank you for rescuing Charlie. I owe you.'

8 'Nah, that's okay, Jack. I was in the tree anyway,' she said with a grin.

9 I watched her go, wondering if she moved like an animal on the ground too. She walked away, arms swinging. I strode in the opposite direction, swinging my arms as if to propel myself into the future.

Text and images: © Jamieson Solutions Pty Limited

Which statement best describes Jack's personality?

- ☐ He is vain and worries about failing in front of others.
- ☐ He is lonely and thinks the girl would be a good friend.
- ☐ He is keen to improve himself.
- ☐ He is unhappy with his circumstances.